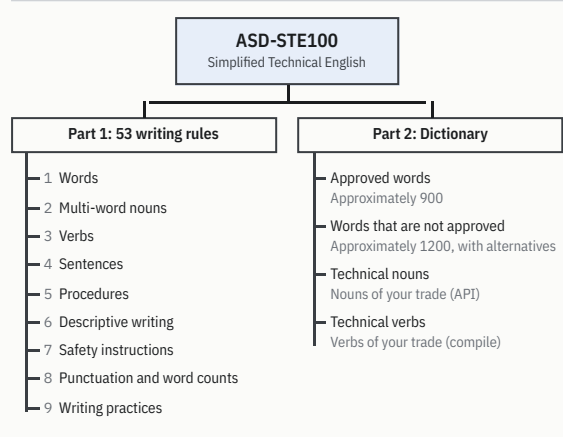


A **Parts of ASD-STE100** Issue 9, January 2025

Issue 9, January 2025

STE is a controlled language for technical documentation.
Each approved word has one meaning, so the text is easier to read and to translate.



Example sentences annotated examples

annotated examples

Not STE: Prior to commencing the update, it is imperative that all services are shut down.

1 Procedural sentence: the same instruction in STE

8 words, limit 20

```
Before you start the update, stop all services.
```

Before you start the update, stop all services.

Condition first Technical noun

Condition first	Technical noun
Command (imperative)	

2 Safety instruction

WARNING: Do not touch the heater. It can burn you.

WARNING: Do not touch the heater. It can burn you.

Risk word First: a clear command Then: the risk

Risk word	First: a clear command	Then: the risk
Must	Must	Must
Should	Should	Should
Could	Could	Could
May	May	May
Will	Will	Will
Can	Can	Can
May	May	May
Could	Could	Could
Should	Should	Should
Must	Must	Must

WARNING: risk of injury or death CAUTION: risk of damage to equipment

WARNING: risk of injury or death CAUTION: risk of damage to equipment

3 Descriptive sentence

3 Descriptive sentence

10 words, limit 25

The script stops when the log is larger than 2 GB.

The script stops when the log is larger than 2 GB.

Simple present, active voice Number and unit: 1 word

Simple present, active voice

Number and unit: 1 word

D Verb forms Section 3

Section 3

Form	Example
✓ Imperative (command)	Stop the fan.
✓ Simple present	The fan stops.
✓ Simple past	The fan stopped.
✓ Simple future	The fan will stop.
✓ Infinitive	Use a key to stop it.
✓ Past participle as adjective	the stopped fan
✗ Progressive, perfect	is stopping, has stopped
✗ Passive in an instruction	It must be stopped.
✗ -ing form as a verb	before stopping it

Use the -ing form only in a technical noun, for example "landing gear".
In descriptive text, use the passive only when the agent is unknown.

E Dictionary entries Part 2 format, Issue 9

Part 2 format, Issue 9

Word	Meaning or alternative	STE example	Not STE
✓ ABOUT (prep)	Concerned with	This page gives data about the API.	Use it only with this meaning
✗ about (adv)	APPROXIMATELY	Wait approximately 10 min.	Wait about 10 min.
✗ check (v)	MAKE SURE	Make sure that the light is on.	Check that the light is on.
✗ test (v)	TEST (n)	Do a test of the alarm.	Test the alarm.
✗ perform (v)	DO	Do the steps in this section.	Perform the steps in this section.
✗ describe (v)	GIVE	This section gives the steps.	This section describes the steps.
✗ need (v)	NECESSARY (adj)	An admin account is necessary .	You need an admin account.
✗ allow (v)	LET	Do not let the disk become full.	Do not allow the disk to fill up.
✗ shut down (v)	STOP	Stop the server.	Shut down the server.
✗ should (v)	MUST	The PIN must have 6 digits.	The PIN should have 6 digits.

UPPERCASE: approved. Lowercase: not approved. An approved word keeps only its approved meaning and part of speech. Technical nouns and verbs are not in the dictionary. Do not use a technical noun as a verb (rule 1.7) or a technical verb as a noun (rule 1.13).

C	Limits	maximum values
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maximum values

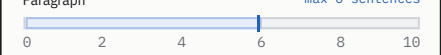
Procedural sentence	max 20 words
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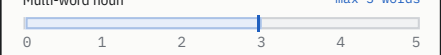
Descriptive sentence max 25 words



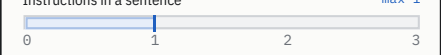
Paragraph	max 6 sentences
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Multi-word noun max 3 words



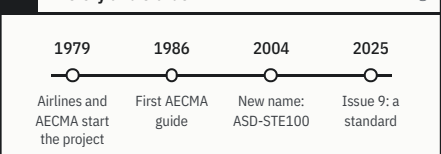
Instructions in a sentence max 1



Write 2 instructions in 1 sentence only when you do the 2 steps at the same time. Count a number and its unit as 1 word. Also count a hyphenated word and text in parentheses as 1 word. In a vertical list, a colon counts as a full stop.

F	History and status	asd-ste100.org
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asd-ste100.org



ATA iSpec 2200 and directives from EASA, FAA and CAAC make STE mandatory for aircraft manuals. S1000D recommends it. Writers also use STE for defense, vehicles, energy and medical devices. The STEMG schedules Issue 10 for January 2028.

Title	Simplified Technical English: overview
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Standard ASD-STE100, Issue 9	Owner ASD, Brussels	
Facts as of 2026-10-03	Revision A	Sheet 1 of 1
Source asd-ste100.org (the standard is a free PDF)		